



MARKET MONITOR

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No. 84 – December 2020

Notwithstanding this month's downgrading of production forecasts for all four AMIS crops, supplies are still considered adequate and trade flows remain robust. However, the resilience in global food markets continues to be in sharp contrast to the increased vulnerability to food insecurity of many economically disadvantaged countries in the wake of the prolonged COVID-19 pandemic. In addition to a fast diminishing purchasing power and domestic supply chain disruptions, higher international prices will raise the financial burden of food imports in many low-income food deficit countries.

Markets at a glance

	From previous forecast	From previous season
Wheat	▼	▼
Maize	▼	▼
Rice	▼	■
Soybeans	▼	▼

▲ Easing ■ Neutral ▼ Tightening

The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations and entities that form the AMIS Secretariat.

Feature article

Are international food markets holding-up during the COVID-19 pandemic?

Early alarms

The onset of the COVID-19 pandemic triggered alarmist views on whether international markets would still have the capacity to meet demands from countries who are dependent on trade for their food security and export earnings. Leading authorities projected precipitous declines in global merchandise trade, reasoning that international supply disruptions and lower global demand fuelled by economic recession would result in sharp contractions in world trade.

How is trade in food expected to fare in 2020?

Data available up to September 2020, projected to the full calendar year of 2020, suggest a contrasting picture of resilience to the global food sector to COVID-19 shocks¹. Indeed, the pessimistic trade forecasts at the global level do not concord with the observed data for food imports for the first nine months of 2020 and the forecast for the remaining months. On the contrary, global volumes of imported foodstuffs look set to increase by more than one percent from 2019, while for developing countries, the resilience is expected to be more remarkable, where imported volumes are anticipated to rise by almost 6 percent, thanks to China's procurement. This comes against a recent strong rebound in many international food prices as measured by FAO's Food Price Index. Among the 11 categories of foodstuffs, the majority of staple foods are expected to register marked increases in global trade quantities in the latter half of 2020, and on average could surpass 2019, but volumes of those which are considered more income elastic are expected to contract in 2020 (i.e., beverages; fish; coffee, tea, cocoa; and dairy); while imports by developing countries, only beverages and fish products, are foreseen to register year-on-year declines.

What about the more vulnerable country groups?

Food imports by the group of Least Developed Countries (LDCs) and the aggregate of countries situated in sub-Saharan Africa (SSA) would be expected to be more vulnerable to COVID-19 shocks,

since lower purchasing power and disruptions to intricate supply chains could be more pronounced. However, LDC imports in 2020 are expected to show little change from 2019, with vegetable oils as well as coffee, tea, cocoa and spices expected to offset declines in many other food categories. For SSA, the picture is very different. Apart from products in the oilseed complex, most other volumes of imported foodstuffs are foreseen to fall in 2020, resulting in an overall contraction of trade, volume-wise, by almost 2 percent compared to 2019.

But vulnerabilities extend elsewhere. COVID-19 is also accentuating the exposure of already economically disadvantaged countries in the financing of their food imports. Countries in North Africa and the Near East have food import dependency rates in the proximity of 90 percent, while 27 countries situated in SSA have rates well above 40 percent. Indeed, Africa and the Near East dominate the intersection of food import vulnerabilities, notably food import dependency, primary commodity export dependency and "commodity currencies", in which exchange rates co-move with world prices of their primary export(s). The ability of these countries to finance food imports is also compromised by risks associated with sovereign debt and credit ratings, both of which govern their ability to access international credit markets.

Even countries that seemingly benefit from low rates of food import dependency such as many situated in Latin America, are still exposed to falling revenues from crude oil and mineral exports as well as real depreciations of their currencies. All-in-all, available evidence suggests that many of the most economically disadvantaged countries are finding it difficult to finance their food imports and, as a consequence, are and will be increasingly exposed to food insecurity.

¹ See <http://www.amis-outlook.org/resources-list/detail/en/c/1152929/>

World supply-demand outlook

- **Wheat** production forecast for 2020 trimmed m/m as downgraded prospects in Argentina and Brazil, as well as a reduced estimate for Kazakhstan, outweighed an upward revision for the Russian Federation.
- Utilization in 2020/21 seen increasing by 1.1 percent from 2019/20 driven by food use, while feed demand is seen constrained by reduced price competitiveness.
- Trade in 2020/21 (July/June) remains close to the 2019/20 record and unchanged m/m with larger sales from the Russian Federation offsetting lower shipments from Argentina.
- Stocks (ending in 2021) lifted by 1.9 million tonnes mostly on an upward correction to the previous estimate of opening stocks in the EU, as well as further adjustments to China's inventories.

- **Maize*** 2020 production forecast to reach an all-time high in spite of this month's sharp downgrading of output in the US, as well as in Ukraine.
- Utilization in 2020/21 to expand slightly faster than earlier anticipated, supported by firmer feed demand, especially in China.
- Trade forecast for 2020/21 (July/June) scaled up further, reflecting even faster pace in purchases by China.
- Stocks (ending 2021) cut by 10 million tonnes, now 19 million tonnes below their opening level, with most of the m/m decrease in the US where inventories are set to fall to their lowest level since 2013/14.

- **Rice** production in 2020 marginally lower m/m, namely on reduced prospects for Bangladesh and Viet Nam, which offset an upward revision for Pakistan.
- Utilization in 2020/21 still anticipated to rise by 1.5 percent, despite some minor revisions this month; overall a food intake expansion to an all-time record is set to drive the season's growth, while all other uses could remain close to 2019/20 levels.
- Trade in 2021 (January-December) raised slightly m/m, as an upward correction to exports from India outweighs downgrades to projected shipments by China, Thailand and Viet Nam.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) downscaled, namely on less buoyant expectations for reserves held by India, the Philippines and Viet Nam; but stock forecasts were raised for China and Thailand.

- **Soybean** 2020/21 production trimmed slightly m/m, with downward corrections for the US and Argentina outpacing a higher forecast for Brazil; global output is still expected to reach a historic record.
- Utilization forecast for 2020/21 lifted on higher estimates for China and several other Asian countries as well as the EU and Brazil, now pointing to a y/y expansion in global consumption of 3.5 percent.
- Trade in 2020/21 (Oct/Sept) raised somewhat, as stronger import demand from the EU and a number of smaller countries is seen outweighing a lower (though still record-high) forecast for China; world trade is now projected to contract fractionally y/y.
- Inventories (2020/21 carry-out) scaled down further, mainly reflecting downward revisions for the US, China and Argentina; with the latest revisions, global ending stocks would fall to a seven-year low.

Wheat	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast
		5 Nov	3 Dec		11 Nov		26 Nov
Prod	762.0	762.7	761.7	764.9	772.4	763.4	765.0
	628.4	628.7	627.7	631.4	636.4	629.8	630.0
Supply	1,033.7	1,038.5	1,038.3	1,049.1	1,073.1	1,025.1	1,043.9
	784.8	776.8	776.6	775.7	785.5	772.9	780.0
Utiliz.	749.5	758.0	757.6	748.3	752.7	746.2	751.8
	624.0	628.1	627.7	622.3	621.7	617.4	619.8
Trade	184.6	184.5	184.5	191.3	190.5	184.3	186.0
	179.4	177.5	177.5	186.0	182.5	177.5	178.1
Stocks	276.6	281.0	282.9	300.8	320.5	278.9	292.1
	148.9	146.3	143.8	149.1	156.8	148.7	152.3

Maize	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2018/19 est	2019/20 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast
		5 Nov	3 Dec		11 Nov		26 Nov
Prod	1,138.2	1,160.3	1,154.8	1,116.2	1,144.6	1,123.9	1,145.9
	877.5	899.3	893.8	855.4	884.6	863.1	887.9
Supply	1,499.5	1,515.1	1,509.6	1,436.0	1,448.0	1,450.5	1,443.6
	1,040.5	1,053.2	1,047.4	965.1	987.4	985.2	994.2
Utiliz.	1,143.2	1,168.5	1,169.2	1,132.7	1,156.5	1,152.8	1,169.0
	877.9	891.7	890.4	854.7	874.5	870.0	880.4
Trade	174.0	179.8	182.5	175.1	183.5	173.6	185.1
	168.6	172.6	172.5	167.5	170.5	164.6	170.1
Stocks	354.8	345.8	335.5	303.3	291.4	297.7	274.6
	153.5	153.7	143.1	102.8	99.9	106.2	98.8

Rice	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast
		5 Nov	3 Dec		11 Nov		26 Nov
Prod	500.7	508.7	508.4	496.1	501.1	496.9	503.4
	357.1	364.5	364.2	349.3	354.1	350.2	355.1
Supply	685.8	691.1	690.2	673.0	679.0	672.4	679.1
	436.8	443.5	442.7	411.3	415.5	416.9	421.3
Utiliz.	502.7	510.3	510.3	495.1	499.2	496.6	500.7
	356.8	363.3	363.2	350.1	352.7	351.0	353.2
Trade	44.5	47.2	47.6	43.7	44.3	42.4	45.0
	41.9	44.6	45.0	41.4	42.1	40.0	42.8
Stocks	181.8	182.0	181.0	177.9	179.8	175.8	178.4
	78.4	81.7	80.4	61.4	63.3	63.4	65.9

Soybeans	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast
		5 Nov	3 Dec		11 Nov		26 Nov
Prod	339.4	368.0	366.4	336.7	362.6	338.4	365.3
	321.3	349.2	347.5	318.6	345.1	320.2	346.5
Supply	402.6	424.7	423.0	449.5	458.0	400.4	414.2
	373.5	386.5	384.8	412.0	413.7	361.6	366.5
Utiliz.	360.3	369.8	373.0	353.9	369.0	351.5	369.5
	252.2	254.4	256.8	244.7	251.6	240.7	251.3
Trade	169.1	166.9	168.2	164.7	167.8	169.6	168.1
	70.5	67.4	69.5	65.8	65.4	68.5	66.6
Stocks	56.9	54.4	49.4	95.3	86.5	48.9	44.7
	37.5	32.3	28.9	68.5	59.7	19.9	13.7

in million tonnes

i Data shown in the second rows refer to world aggregates without China; world trade data refer to exports and world trade without China excludes exports to China.

To review and compare data, by country and commodity, across three main sources, go to <https://app.amis-outlook.org/#/market-database/view-and-compare>

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies.

* The 2020/21 AMIS-FAO world maize production forecast includes southern hemisphere maize crops harvested in 2020 whereas IGC and USDA include southern hemisphere maize crops to be harvested in 2021 in their 2020/21 world production numbers.

For more information see Explanatory notes on the last page of this report.

Revisions (FAO-AMIS) to 2020/21 forecasts since the previous report

in thousand tonnes

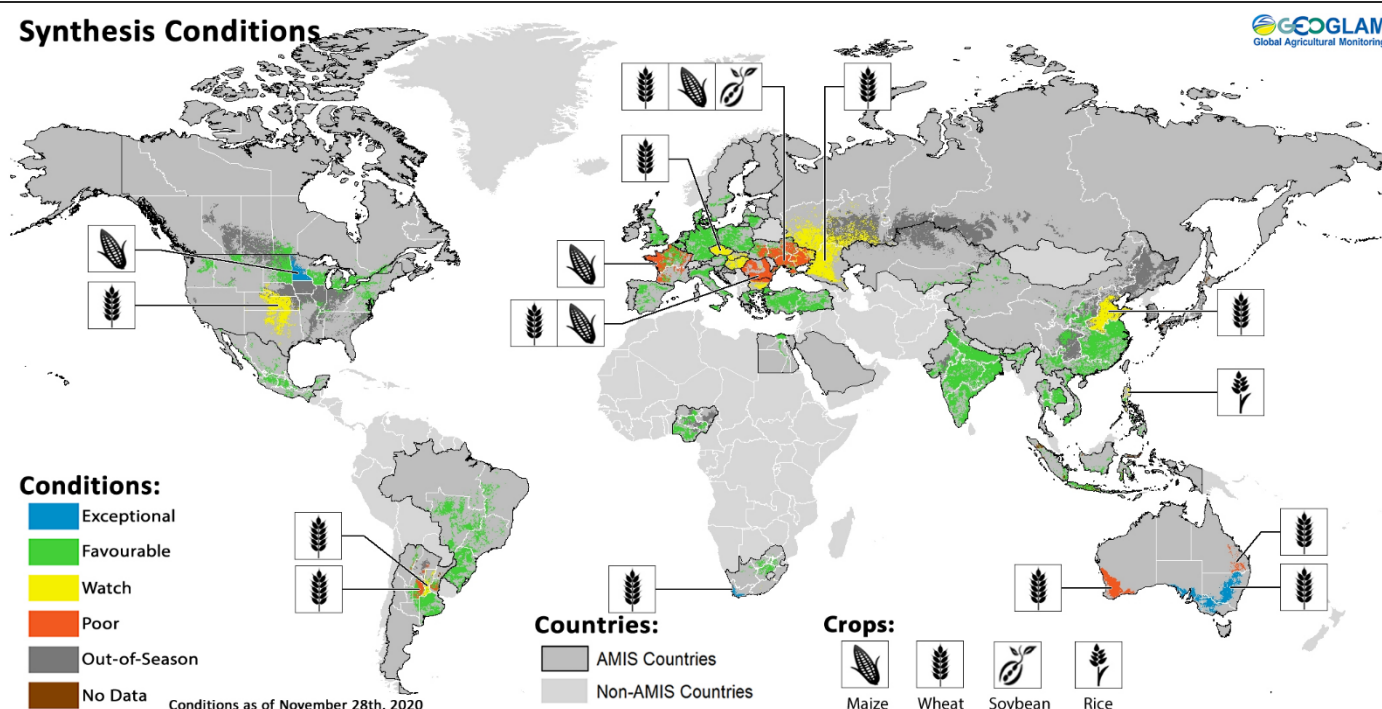
	WHEAT					MAIZE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	-970	-4	-430	-4	1889	-5487	2738	654	2750	-10252
Total AMIS	-609	76	-316	96	1616	-6851	2750	-96	2400	-10146
Argentina	-1,000	-	-	-1,000	-100	-	-	-	-	-
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-479	100	-229	-	-150	-	-	-	-	-
Canada	-	-	72	-	400	-	-	-200	-	200
China Mainland	-	-	-	-	500	-	2800	2000	-	406
Egypt	-	-	-700	600	299	-	-	-	-	-
EU	395	-	353	-	1000	48	-	48	-	-
India	-	-	-100	-	-	500	50	-	-100	1058
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-500	-	-	-500	-	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-25	-	-25	-	-	200	-	200	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	100	100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	1,000	-	-	1,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-	-182	-	-182	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-	-2000	-	-	-2000	-
UK	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	-	-	163	-	-163	-5459	-	-1904	4500	-11810
Viet Nam	-	-124	50	-4	-170	42	-100	-58	-	-

	RICE					SOYBEANS				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	-266	410	-8	440	-959	-1602	1228	3169	1313	-5024
Total AMIS	-527	-105	-284	195	-1156	-1432	426	2228	1293	-5019
Argentina	-27	-	-1	-	-15	-500	-50	-100	200	-700
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-	-	-73	-	-48	1500	150	550	1000	100
Canada	-	-	-15	-	-55	-	-	-	-	-
China Mainland	-	-	71	-200	300	20	-800	720	-	-1600
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
EU	-	-	-	-	-	-	900	700	-	200
India	-	-	-370	1500	-1700	-	-	-50	-	-
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	58	-	30	15	28	-	15	-10	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Nigeria	85	-	45	-	40	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-205	-100	-	-250	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-124	-	-47	-	-75	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	47	-	-23	30	30	300	-	300	-	-200
Saudi Arabia	-	100	-	-	50	-	100	105	-	-
South Africa	-	-	55	-	35	-	51	-50	-1	-49
Thailand	-	-	195	-700	600	-	-	40	-	-40
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-	-	-2	-	-3	-102	10	-120	44	-
UK	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	-6	-	-0	-50	57	-2650	-	80	50	-2730
Viet Nam	-559	-	-49	-400	-150	-	50	63	-	-

Crop monitor

Crop conditions in AMIS countries (as of 28 November)

Synthesis Conditions



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of 28 November. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. **Only crops that are in other-than-favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.**

Conditions at a glance

Wheat - In the southern hemisphere, harvesting is ongoing in Argentina and Australia under mixed conditions. In the northern hemisphere, winter wheat sowing is completed with a few areas of concern in eastern Europe, Ukraine, the Russian Federation, China and the US.

Maize - In the northern hemisphere, harvest is wrapping up under mixed conditions. In the southern hemisphere, Argentina and Brazil are sowing the early-planted and spring-planted crops respectively under generally favourable conditions.

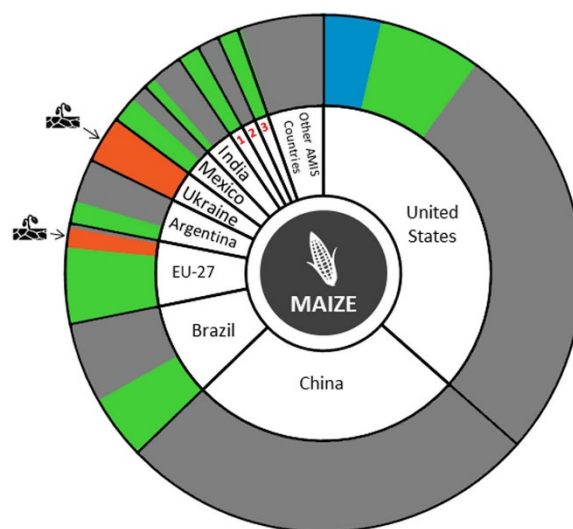
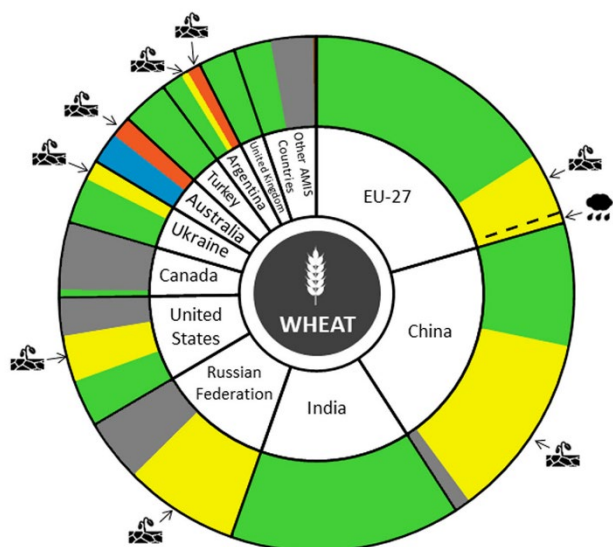
Rice - Harvesting wrapping up for late rice in China and ongoing for Kharif rice in India. In Southeast Asia, harvest is ongoing for wet-season rice in the northern countries and dry-season rice in Indonesia. The northern Philippines has been negatively impacted by several recent Typhoons.

Soybeans - In the northern hemisphere, harvesting is wrapping up while in the southern hemisphere, sowing continues in Brazil and Argentina under generally favourable conditions.

La Niña advisory

The El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is currently in the La Niña phase, with very cool ocean conditions in the eastern equatorial Pacific. La Niña conditions are expected to continue during January to March (~95 percent chance) and potentially through March to May (~65 percent chance).

La Niña conditions typically reduce December to February/May rainfall in East Africa, the southern US, the northern Middle East, southern Central Asia, Afghanistan, Pakistan, and India. Southern Brazil, northern Argentina, eastern China, the Korean Peninsula, and southern Japan typically see reduced rainfall into January. La Niña conditions typically increase December to February/May rainfall in Southeast Asia, Southern Africa, southern Central America, northern South America, and in southernmost India and Sri Lanka. Australia and Indonesia typically see increased rainfall into December.

Conditions:**Drivers:**

Canada¹, Russian Federation², South Africa³

Wheat

In **Argentina**, harvest is beginning under mixed conditions with prolonged dryness in the north and favourable conditions in Buenos Aires and La Pampa provinces. In **Australia**, harvesting is progressing under mixed conditions with above-average yields in New South Wales, Victoria, and South Australia, while persistent dryness during the season has resulted in below-average yields for Western Australia and Queensland. A large increase in sown area is estimated across the country compared to last year. In the **EU**, conditions are generally favourable as winter wheat sowing is complete, however, some countries in eastern Europe are behind in crop development due to excessive rainfall in October. In **Ukraine**, conditions are generally favourable as recent warm weather extended the growth and development of crops going into winter; only persistent dryness in the east remains of some concern. In the **Russian Federation**, winter wheat sowing is complete under mixed conditions due to drought conditions in the south and minimal rainfall in the Volga and Central districts. There is a slight increase in total sown area compared to last year. In **China**, winter wheat is developing under generally favourable conditions albeit with some dry conditions slowing development in the Huanghuai region. In **India**, sowing is progressing ahead of schedule in the northern and central states under favourable conditions. In the **US**, winter wheat is under mixed conditions due to dryness in the southern Great Plains. In **Canada**, conditions are favourable as the sowing of winter wheat is complete with a slight increase in sown area in Ontario.

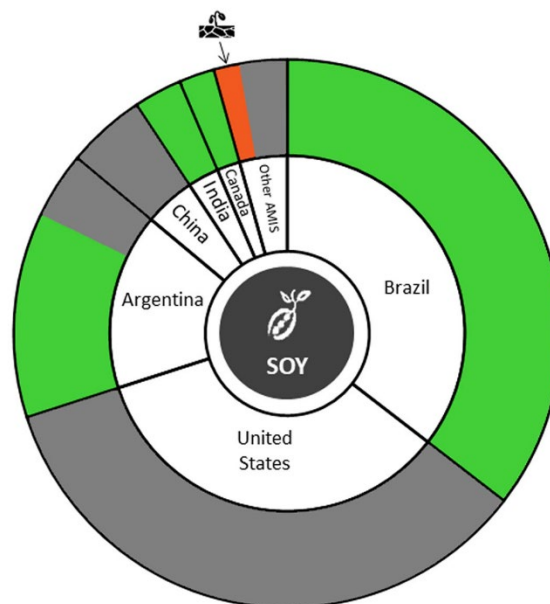
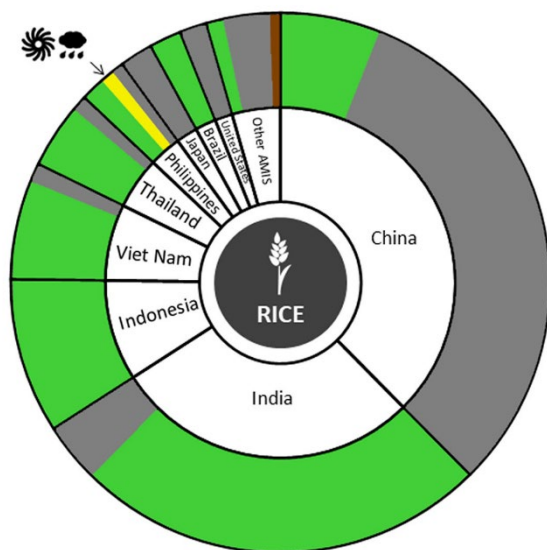
Maize

In the **US**, harvesting is wrapping up under favourable conditions with above-average yields in Minnesota and Illinois. In **Canada**, conditions are favourable as harvest wraps up. In **Mexico**, harvesting of the spring-summer crop (larger season) is ongoing under favourable conditions. In the **EU**, harvest is wrapping up under generally favourable conditions except for France, Bulgaria, and Romania where summer drought has reduced yields. In **Ukraine**, harvesting is wrapping up under poor conditions due to the severe summer drought pushing yields below the 5 and 10-year averages. In **India**, the Rabi crop has started being sowed under favourable conditions. In **Brazil**, conditions are generally favourable for the spring-planted crop (smaller season) with some areas of dryness in the southeast and south regions affecting crops. There is an expected slight decrease in the total sown area compared to last year. In **Argentina**, sowing for the early-planted crop (larger season) is complete under favourable conditions while sowing of the late-planted crop (smaller season) has begun where soil moisture conditions permit. In **South Africa**, sowing has begun under favourable conditions owing to widespread rains.



Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average), with the main producing countries (95 percent of production) shown individually and the remaining 5 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. Sections within each country are weighted by the sub-national production statistics (5-year average) of the respective country and accounts for multiple cropping seasons (i.e. spring and winter wheat).

The late vegetative through to reproductive crop growth stages are generally the most sensitive periods for crop development.

Conditions:**Drivers:****Rice**

In **China**, harvesting of late rice is wrapping up under favourable conditions. In **India**, conditions are favourable for Kharif rice as harvest is wrapping up in the northern states and beginning in the southern and eastern states. In **Indonesia**, harvesting of dry-season rice is wrapping up under favourable conditions with a noticeable increase in harvested area compared to last year. Sowing of wet-season rice is continuing under favourable conditions, albeit slowly due to uneven rainfall. In **Viet Nam**, harvesting of wet-season rice in the north is wrapping up under favourable conditions. In the south, conditions are favourable as the harvesting of the summer-autumn (wet-season) crop is wrapping up and the harvesting of the autumn-winter (wet-season) crop continues. Sowing of the winter-spring (dry-season) crop in the south has begun under favourable conditions. In **Thailand**, wet-season rice is in the grain filling stage under favourable conditions with an increase in total sown area compared to last year. In the **Philippines**, wet-season rice is harvesting under mixed conditions due to three tropical cyclones that have brought lodging and flooding damage to parts of Northern and Southern Luzon.

Soybeans

In **Canada**, harvest is wrapping up under favourable conditions with yields slightly above-average. In **India**, conditions are favourable as the harvest wraps up. In **Ukraine**, harvest is wrapping up under poor conditions with yields below the five-year average due to prolonged drought during the season. In **Brazil**, conditions are favourable as recent rainfall in the main producing Central-West region has facilitated crop development. On the contrary, limited and irregular rainfall in the South region has affected crops, however, expected yields remain stable. There is an estimated increase in total sown area compared to last year. In **Argentina**, conditions are favourable as recent rains are supporting sowing across the main growing areas. However, additional rainfall is still needed in parts of Entre Ríos, La Pampa, and the north to complete sowing.

Information on crop conditions in non-AMIS countries can be found in the [GEOGLAM Early Warning Crop Monitor](#), published 3 December 2020

Policy developments

Wheat

- With effect from 3 November, **Brazil** requires wheat shipments from Lithuania to be declared free of certain insects and fungi based on official laboratory analysis, as notified to the WTO (G/SPS/N/BRA/1680 and /Corr.1). Brazil also notified the WTO of the adoption of *flubendiamide* maximum residue limits (MRLs) used on wheat (BRA/1772/Add.1).
- On 23 November, Health Regulatory Agency in **Brazil** notified the WTO of new proposed MRLs for *mancozeb* used on wheat (G/SPS/N/BRA/1830).
- On 18 November, **Canada** notified the WTO of proposed changes to MRLs for *tetraconazole* (G/SPS/N/CAN/1351), *chlormequat chloride* (CAN/1352), which apply to wheat.

Maize

- On 12 November, **Brazil** notified the adoption of MRLs for *ethiprole* used on maize (G/SPS/N/BRA/1765/Add.1).

Rice

- On 5 November, **Brazil's** Health Regulatory Agency notified the WTO of changes to MRLs for inorganic arsenic (G/SPS/N/BRA/1824) in rice, in line with CODEX standard CXS 193-1995.
- On 3 November, **Canada** notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs for *triflumezopyrim* (G/SPS/N/CAN/1323/Add.1) for rice.
- On 9 November, **Japan's** Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs on *ipflufenquin* (G/SPS/N/JPN/746) and *benzpyrimoxan* (758/Add.1) used on rice.
- Following amendments to the **US** Generalized System of Preferences, a wide range of agricultural and non-agricultural products, including parboiled rice, will no longer enjoy duty-free access to the US market as of 1 January 2021.

Soybeans

- On 2 November, **Argentina's** Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Fisheries published Decree 786/20 in the Official Journal, launching the Compensation and Stimulus Program for small-scale soybean producers. Around 40 percent of Argentina's soybean producers will receive compensation payments, which will be calculated based on declared tonnage sold and hectares planted in 2019 with respective caps of 400 hectares and 20 million pesos.

- On 12 November, **Brazil** notified the WTO of amendments to *cartap* MRLs (G/SPS/N/BRA/1770) for soybeans.
- In November, **Japan's** Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare notified the adoption of several pesticide MRLs used on soybeans, including *ametoctradin* (G/SPS/N/JPN/733), *1,3-dichloropropene* (745/Add.1), *benthiavalicarb-isopropyl* (719/Add.1), *isofetamid* (JPN/747).

Across the board

- On 19 November, **Australia** notified the WTO of additional emergency measures against increasing infestation risks arising from the spread of khapra beetle in shipping containers. Moreover, amendments to SPS certification and offshore treatment requirements will apply to high risk plants. Phytosanitary certification requirements of all seeds for sowing are expected to be implemented as the course of the second half of 2021 (G/SPS/N/AUS/502/Add.3).
- On 15 November, **Australia**, Brunei, Cambodia, **China**, **Indonesia**, **Japan**, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, New Zealand, the **Philippines**, Singapore, **South Korea**, **Thailand** and **Viet Nam** signed the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP). Overall, the Agreement will significantly facilitate trade and reduce tariffs on goods among the 15 participating countries by 90 percent over ten years. RCEP also strengthens rules on state-owned enterprises, competition, rules of origin, and product standards.
- On 3 November, the Ministry of Agriculture in **Brazil** issued Normative Instruction No. 60/2020 to facilitate imports of genetically modified (GM) maize and soybean from the US by recognizing the equivalence of the respective GM approval procedures. In particular, the new rule revokes prior conditions requiring relevant GM information to be specified in import licences for products intended to be used in animal feed or for veterinary use.
- On 16 November, **Canada** established *broflanilide* MRLs that will apply to all food crops (G/SPS/N/CAN/1311/Add.1).
- In the WTO dispute settlement proceedings regarding China's tariff quota administration for wheat, rice and maize, **China** and the **US** agreed to extend the compliance deadline once more to 31 December 2020.
- On 11 November, **Egypt** enacted a new Customs Law aimed at facilitating foreign investment and international trade by harmonizing and streamlining customs operations and procedures, enhancing the efficiency of import and export audit systems, and leveraging modern technologies and electronic clearance and invoicing systems (No. 207/2020). Implementing regulations are expected to be

issued within six months. On 25 November, the Ministry of Finance also announced having submitted a Bill to Parliament to exempt import cargoes on wheat, pulses and other goods, from VAT on sea freight services

- On 5 November, the **EU** notified the WTO of the adoption of, and amendments to, MRLs for a range of pesticides that are used on several crops, including wheat, maize and rice (G/SPS/N/EU/379/Add.1; EU/443; EU/444).
- In view of increased plantings of rice, maize, cotton, soybeans and sugarcane, on 13 November, **India's** Ministry of Finance earmarked an additional RBL 650 billion (USD 8.71 billion) in fertilizer subsidies for the current 2020-21 fiscal year, in contrast with a previous government decision to reduce the fertilizer subsidy allocation by 11 percent in February 2020.
- In November, **Japan's** Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare notified the WTO of the adoption, modification, or proposed establishment, of numerous pesticide MRLs used on various crops, including wheat, rice, maize and soybeans (G/SPS/N/JPN/713/Add.1; 717/Add.1; 718/Add.1; 734/Add.1; 737/Add.1; 738/Add.1; 741/Add.1 to 743/Add.1; 748/Add.1; 761/Add.1; 762/Add.1; JPN/790; JPN/800 to JPN/803).
- On 4 November, the Ministry of Agriculture in **Mexico** announced a financial loans scheme worth around USD 70 million intended to support the production of at least 8 million tons of grains (of which, 70 percent is maize; 15 percent is wheat; and 15 percent is sorghum) in the 2020-21 autumn-winter cycle.
- Following ratification by **Nigeria** on 12 November, the African Continental Free Trade Area will now come into effect on 1 January 2021.
- On 3 November, **Thailand** approved a budget allocation of THB 61.9 billion (USD 199.5 million) to support the incomes of rice and rubber farmers. Of the total budget, THB 51.2 billion is allocated to the rice guarantee programme to continue supporting prices between October 2020 and May 2021 at similar rates as the previous season. In addition, interest-free loans will be introduced to encourage the storage of rice between 1 November 2020 and 29 February 2021 with a view to delaying seasonal sales, with farmers receive THB 500 and farming cooperatives THB 1 000 for each tonne of rice stored. To foster value addition, farm cooperatives will receive a 1 percent soft loan from 1 October 2020 until 30 September 2021. With respect to rice trading, firms will be rewarded with a 3 percent interest for storing rice during 2-6 months in addition to reimbursements for storage costs incurred from 1 November 2020 until 31 March 2021.
- On 11 November, the **UK** Parliament approved the Agriculture Act that paves the way for a 7-year transition to a new compensation mechanism centered on the delivery of public goods, such as fostering biodiversity, environmental protection, sustainable soil management, and improving air and water quality, while increases in

agricultural productivity and technological uptake will be encouraged. Direct payments under the EU Common Agriculture Policy (approximately USD 3.96 billion) will be phased out between 2021 and 2027. A report analysing the food security situation in the UK must be presented to Parliament every 3 years.

Trade Junctures and Logistics

- In November, **Argentina** faced ongoing protests and strikes at grain ports in protest for the deadlock in wage re-negotiations. The strikes affected the shipment and unloading of grain in Puerto San Lorenzo as well as export activity from the country's main grains hub of Rosario.
- In **India**, farmers intensified demonstrations against the government's efforts to deregulate wholesale agricultural markets, lessen reliance on minimum support prices, and removing cereals, pulses, oilseeds, edible oils, onions and potatoes from the list of essential commodities. Road blockades have started disrupting supply chains for fresh agricultural products, causing food prices to increase.

Stop-press

- On 29 October, **China's** Central Committee of the Communist Party adopted proposals for the formulation of the 14th Five-Year Plan (2021-2025) for National Economic and Social Development, which is expected to be released in March 2021. In the area of agriculture, the Plan outlines several priorities such as: poverty alleviation and effective support services to vulnerable rural communities; enhancing food security; improving the quality, efficiency and competitiveness of agriculture; implementing high standard infrastructure and conservation projects; improving seed quality, developing agricultural insurance, investing in innovative farm technologies and smart agriculture systems, and improving pest and disease control systems.

International prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Nov 2020 Average*	% Change M/M	% Change Y/Y
GOI	244	+ 4.8%	+ 28.3 %
Wheat	212	+ 1.5 %	+ 16.7 %
Maize	240	+ 4.9 %	+ 35.2 %
Rice	186	+ 0.6 %	+ 15.5 %
Soybeans	250	+ 7.3 %	+ 37.0 %

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat

World export prices rose by around 2 percent on average in the past month, but with mixed movements at the major origins. Declining production expectations in Argentina provided support, but this was countered by ideas that Australia's harvest might be bigger than anticipated. Increasing competition from Australian supplies in major markets weighed on export values in the Russian Federation. Here, many analysts saw the volume of proposed export quotas as not restricting shipments below previously anticipated levels. Underpinning to world export prices continued to come from worries about 2021/22 production prospects due to a less than ideal start to the growing season in the US and the Black Sea region. Prices in the EU were strongly higher on relatively good exports after the below-average harvest and a generally tightening outlook for total local grains supplies.

Maize

Global export values rose for a sixth successive month on tightening supply and demand fundamentals. Including export price gains across all major origins, the IGC GOI sub-Index increased by 5 percent, to a fresh six-year peak. Amid cuts to official production and closing stock estimates, US prices strengthened, but with quotations still at a discount to competing suppliers. Sentiment was also buoyed by China's emergence as a major buyer, with growing expectations for record imports in 2020/21. Dry weather in parts of South America was generally supportive, especially in Brazil, where spot availabilities dwindled due to sustained solid domestic and overseas demand. Despite better results from the latter stages of the harvest, quotations in Ukraine

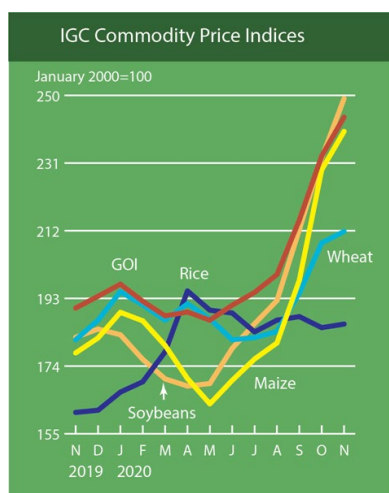
climbed on slow farmer selling, tied to a much smaller exportable surplus.

Rice

Despite harvesting pressure in several Asian exporters, average international rice prices were stronger over the past month. Vietnamese quotes rose to a nine-year high following storms which boosted domestic demand and delayed harvesting. Thai values also firmed, on strength in the local currency and with sentiment underpinned by high Vietnamese values, albeit as main crop paddy arrivals and subdued buying interest pared gains. In contrast, Indian offers declined on seasonal harvesting pressure, with some offsetting support from government paddy procurement.

Soybeans

Representing the seventh successive monthly increase in average global values, the IGC-GOI sub-Index advanced by 7 percent in November, taking the y/y gain to more than one-third. US market sentiment was buoyed by strong underlying export demand – with 2020/21 (Sep/Aug) commitments already equivalent to more than 80 percent of the full-season forecast – and lingering worries about the impact of dryness on South American crops, despite an uptick in planting progress in recent weeks. Stronger markets for vegetable oils, coupled with gains in equities and crude oil, added to the positive tone at times. While Brazilian (spot) prices moved higher, physical trade was especially light given meagre old crop supplies and, as such, offers were seen as nominal. Argentine prices were again largely underpinned by reluctant grower sales.



		IGC commodity price indices				
		GOI	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(..... January 2000 = 100)				
2019	November	190.3	181.4	177.7	161.0	182.1
	December	193.6	186.9	181.9	161.6	184.4
2020	January	197.0	194.9	189.1	166.7	182.8
	February	192.2	191.2	186.7	169.6	175.9
	March	188.1	186.9	179.8	178.0	170.4
	April	189.2	191.5	170.5	195.1	168.4
	May	186.9	187.3	163.4	189.7	169.1
	June	191.1	181.4	170.0	188.9	179.0
	July	194.7	182.0	176.0	183.6	185.9
	August	199.7	183.7	180.5	186.9	192.4
	September	215.0	194.5	198.1	187.9	212.3
	October	233.0	208.6	229.1	184.8	232.5
	November	243.9	211.8	239.9	185.8	249.1

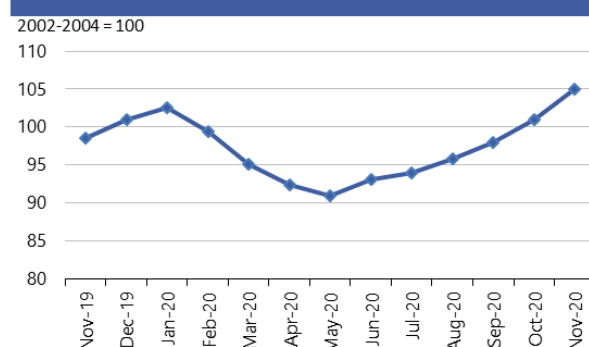
Selected export prices, currencies and indices



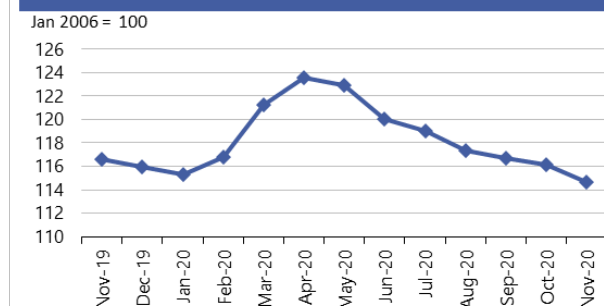
Daily quotations of selected export prices						
	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Month ago (2)	Year ago (3)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (3)
..... USD/tonne						
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	27-Nov	270	261	223	3.4%	21.1%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	25-Nov	192	175	164	9.2%	16.6%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	27-Nov	492	483	404	1.9%	21.8%
Soybeans (US No. 2, Yellow)	27-Nov	485	433	347	12.0%	39.8%

AMIS Countries' Currencies Against US Dollar				
AMIS Countries	Currency	Nov 2020 Average	Monthly Change	Annual Change
Argentina	ARS	79.9	-3.1%	-34.0%
Australia	AUD	1.4	2.2%	6.3%
Brazil	BRL	5.4	3.5%	-30.6%
Canada	CAD	1.3	1.1%	1.3%
China	CNY	6.6	1.9%	6.0%
Egypt	EGP	15.6	0.3%	2.9%
EU	EUR	0.8	0.6%	6.7%
India	INR	74.2	-0.9%	-3.8%
Indonesia	IDR	14,184.0	3.4%	-0.9%
Japan	JPY	104.4	0.8%	4.1%
Kazakhstan	KZT	428.6	0.2%	-10.6%
Rep. Korea	KRW	1,114.3	2.6%	4.6%
Mexico	MXN	20.4	4.1%	-5.6%
Nigeria	NGN	380.7	0.0%	-24.3%
Philippines	PHP	48.2	0.5%	4.9%
Russian Fed.	RUB	76.6	1.1%	-20.0%
Saudi Arabia	SAR	3.8	0.0%	0.0%
South Africa	ZAR	15.5	5.7%	-4.9%
Thailand	THB	30.4	2.6%	-0.7%
Turkey	TRY	8.0	-0.1%	-38.7%
UK	GBP	0.8	1.8%	2.5%
Ukraine	UAH	28.3	0.1%	-16.5%
Viet Nam	VND	23,169.0	0.1%	0.1%

FAO Food Price Index
Nov 2019 - Nov 2020



Nominal Broad Dollar Index
Nov 2019 - Nov 2020



Source: US Federal Reserve

Futures market (US)

Futures Prices – nearby

	Nov-20 Average	% Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	220	-1.2%	16.1%
Maize	164	4.2%	11.3%
Rice	274	-0.3%	3.8%
Soybeans	420	8.3%	26.1%

Source: CME

Futures Prices

Futures prices for maize and soybeans rose for the fourth consecutive month while wheat futures, after reaching a 6-year high in October, eased nominally m/m. Progressively lower estimates for US crops leading to projections of multi-year low ending stocks sustained upward pressure on values. In addition, la Niña-related dry weather concerns in South America and record global demand, led by China, were significant price drivers. Despite record high domestic grain prices in the Black Sea region because of its reduced wheat supplies, the absence of additional regional export curbs to date helped temper wheat benchmark prices. Rice values were about unchanged m/m as global supply and demand remained in equilibrium. Regarding exogenous markets, the US dollar index continued in a narrow range for the third consecutive month, while crude oil prices, highly dependent on road travel, continued to languish. In all, the rally in grain and oilseed prices over the past few months defied projections for lowered global agricultural trade and consumption trends as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. Prices for wheat, maize, soybeans and rice were 16.1, 11.3, 26.1 and 3.8 percent higher respectively y/y.

Volumes and volatility

Trade volumes for wheat, maize and soybeans declined m/m despite the persistent price rally which typically attracts speculative interest. Volumes also fell y/y except for soybeans. Implied and historical volatility was unchanged to slightly lower m/m for the three commodities while both measures displayed higher levels y/y for all three commodities. Current levels, however, registering mostly in the low twenties, would be considered subdued.

Basis levels and transport

Domestic basis levels were steady m/m, even as the US harvest completed. In Illinois, average quotes to local elevators were minus USD 4 per tonne for maize, and minus USD 4 per tonne for soybeans, each under the respective December and January futures prices. In Iowa, maize and soybean bids were minus USD 7 and minus USD 20, respectively. Soft red wheat bids for delivery to northern flour mills, were discounted to December futures. Record export demand kept maize and soybean bids delivered to gulf firm m/m at USD 27 and USD 26 per

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages		
	Nov-20	Oct-20	Nov-19
Wheat	22.4	29.2	19.7
Maize	21.3	21.7	19.9
Rice	14.7	19.1	13.4
Soybeans	18.6	21.1	11.4

tonne over respective futures, although easing somewhat m/m in a rapidly changing price environment. Soft red wheat values were thinly quoted at around USD 33. Elevation margins at the New Orleans Gulf (the difference between barge shipments delivered gulf and free on board vessel) maintained outsized levels of over USD 20 per tonne as gulf export elevators remained stretched to operating capacity. Heavy barge traffic on the Illinois River – resuming for six weeks following lock and dam repairs – traded as high as USD 34 per tonne but eased back to USD 26 at end month. The USDA reported that accumulated exports and sales commitments for maize and soybeans were continuing at a record pace – with total commitments – including outstanding sales and accumulated exports – more than twice the levels recorded same time last year. China remained the most prodigious buyer of the two commodities. Wheat exports and forward sales also surpassed the previous year.

Forward curves

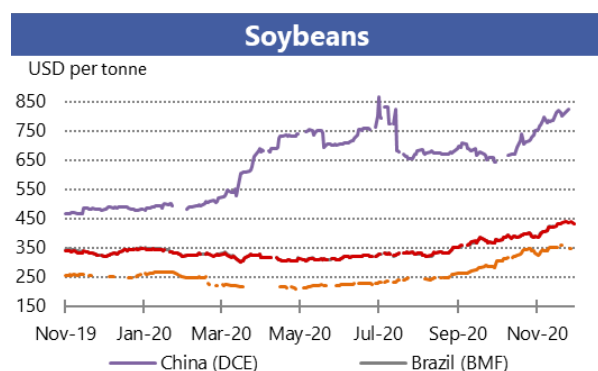
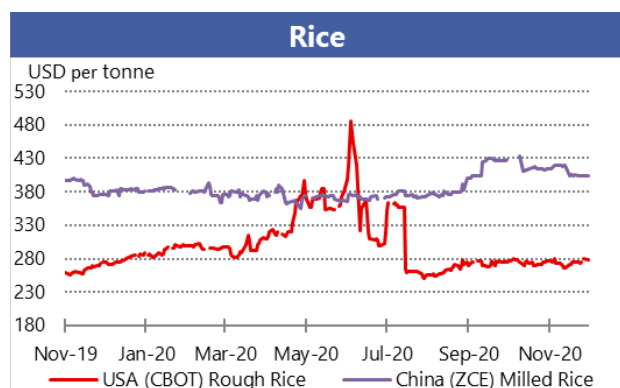
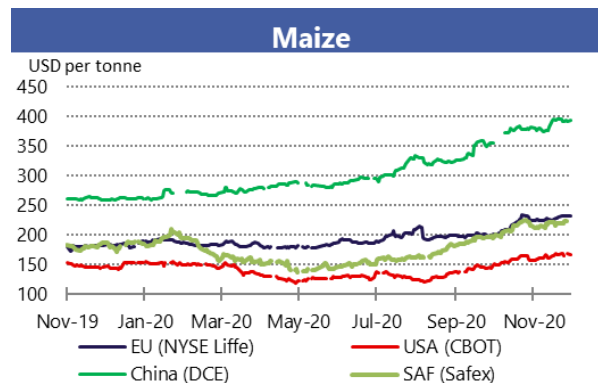
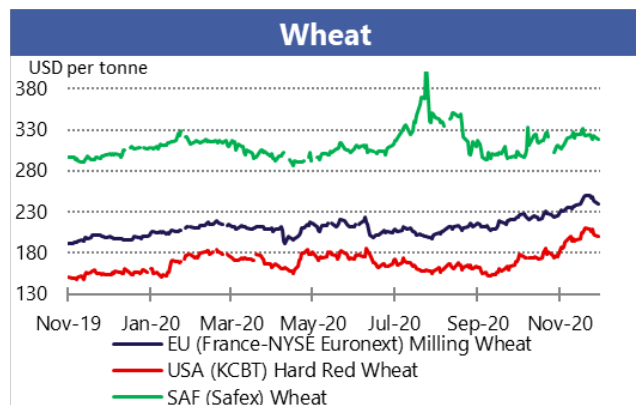
Forward curves for wheat and maize displayed small changes m/m with wheat nearby futures relaxing relative to deferred months and the maize market continuing to show an inverse between the December 2020 and December 2021 contracts. The forward curve for soybeans between January 2021 and November 2021 displayed increasing backwardation (downward sloping) as the USDA lowered US ending stocks-to-use ratio to 4 percent, the lowest level in 7 years.

Investment flows

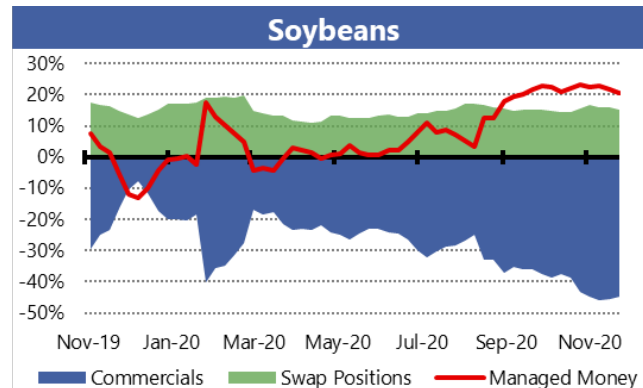
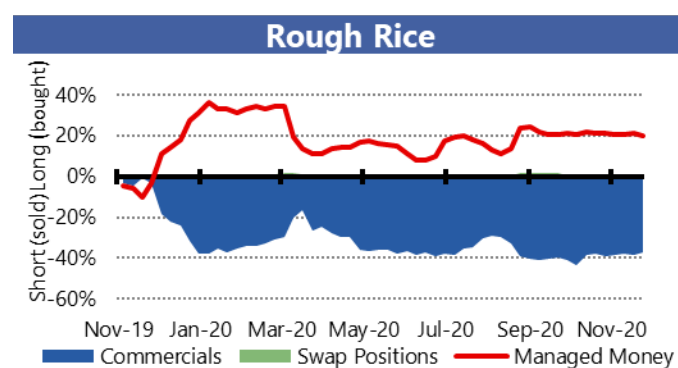
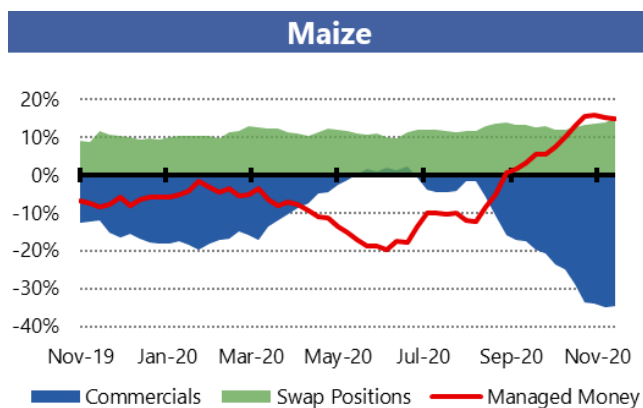
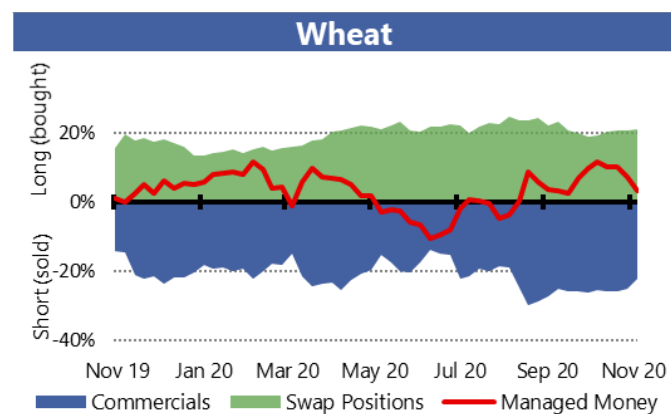
Managed money held onto large net long positions m/m in maize and soybeans, while trimming net long positions in wheat following a near-term price plateau. In typical post maize and soybean harvest pattern, commercials maintained large net short positions in the two commodities. In the case of maize, they held the largest net short recorded in 10 years and in the case of soybeans, the largest net short recorded since the CFTC began publishing its COT Report in 2006.

Market indicators

Daily quotations from leading exchanges - nearby futures

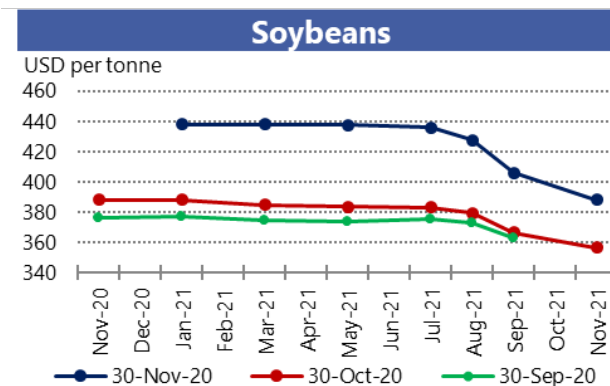
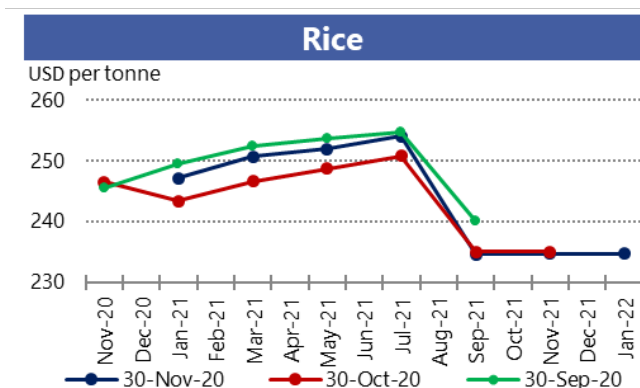
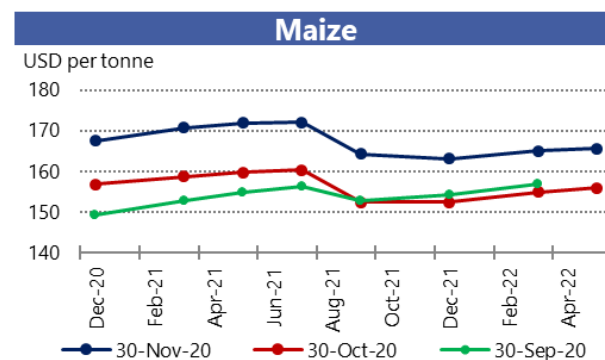
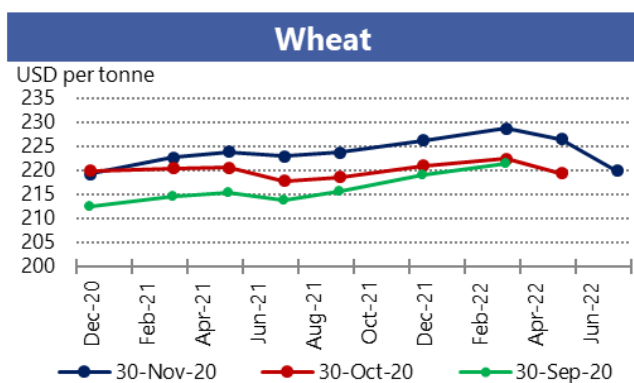


CFTC Commitments of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

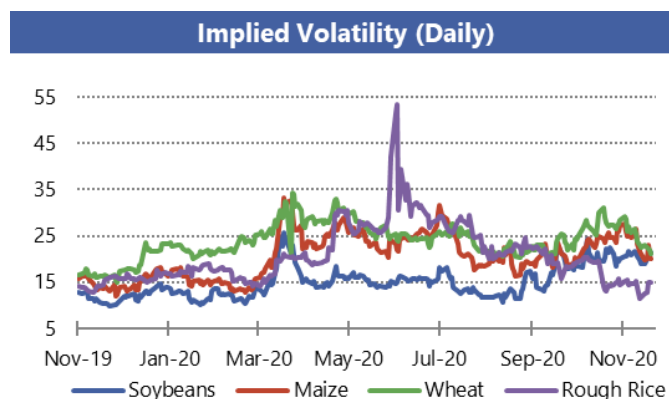
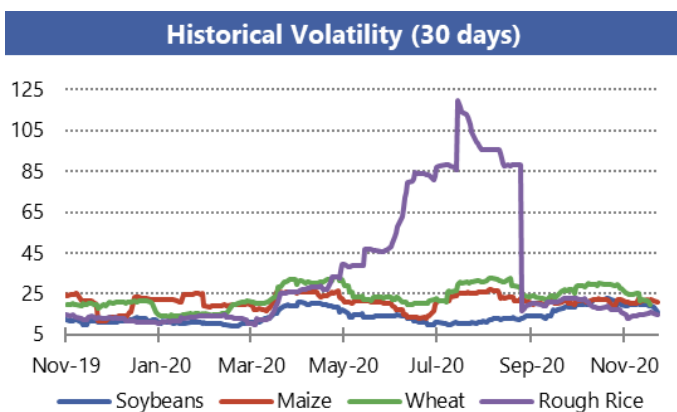


**Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.*

Forward Curves



Historical and Implied Volatilities



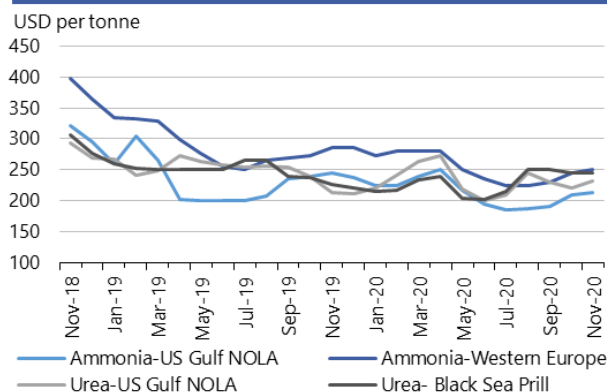
AMIS Market indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at: <http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/>

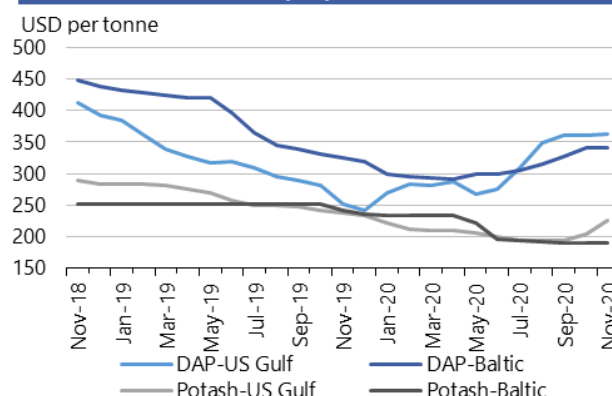
*For more information about Forward Curves see the feature article in [No. 75 February AMIS Market Monitor 2020](#).

Fertilizer outlook

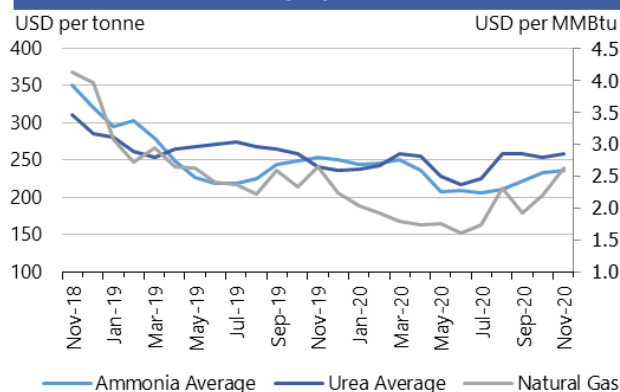
Ammonia and Urea
(Spot prices)



Potash and Phosphate
(Spot prices)



Ammonia Average, Urea Average and Natural Gas
(Spot prices)



Note: Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers.
Own elaboration based on Bloomberg.

- **Natural gas** prices continued their upward trend due to arrival of cold fronts in the northern hemisphere.
- Supply restrictions and the start of the application season in the US, combined with a higher demand for phosphate production, pushed **ammonia** prices upward worldwide.
- Despite a slowdown in demand, **urea** prices rose, especially in the US, due to supply limitations.
- **DAP** prices flatten with demand shifts from Asia to Europe and the US and constant inventories.
- **Potash** prices increased by over 10 percent m/m in the US due to the seasonal demand peak for fertilizer application.

	November average	November std. dev	% change last month*	% change last year*	12-month high	12-month low
Ammonia-US Gulf NOLA	213.0	-	1.7%	-13.1%	250	186
Ammonia-Western Europe	250.0	-	2.3%	-12.3%	285	225
Urea-US Gulf	232.7	11.0	5.8%	9.4%	272.8	199.5
Urea-Black Sea	245.0	-	0.0%	8.4%	251.0	203.0
DAP-US Gulf	362.7	2.5	0.7%	44.0%	362.7	241
DAP-Baltic	340.0	-	0.0%	4.6%	340	291
Potash-Baltic	190.0	-	0.0%	-21.0%	234.7	190
Potash- US Gulf NOLA	225.0	10.0	10.4%	-5.1%	234.0	193
Ammonia	236.0	0.4	1.4%	-7.1%	250.3	206.5
Urea	257.7	3.0	1.3%	6.7%	259.1	217
Natural Gas	2.6	0.2	18.9%	-1.3%	2.6	1.6

All prices shown are in US dollars.

Source: Own elaboration based on Bloomberg



Chart and tables description * Estimated using available weekly data to date.

Ammonia and Urea: Overview of nitrogen-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Western Europe and Black Sea. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Potash and Phosphate: Overview of phosphate and potassium-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Baltic and Vancouver. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Ammonia Average and Urea Average: Monthly average prices from Ammonia's US Gulf NOLA, Middle East, Black Sea and Western Europe were averaged to obtain Ammonia Average prices; monthly average prices from Urea's US Gulf NOLA, US Gulf Prill, Middle East Prill, Black Sea Prill and Mediterranean were averaged to obtain Urea Average prices.

Natural Gas: Henry Hub Natural Gas Spot Price from ICE up to December 2017 and from Bloomberg (BGAP) from January 2018 onwards. Prices are intraday prices averaged by month. Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers

DAP: Diammonium Phosphate.

Ocean freight markets

Dry bulk freight market developments

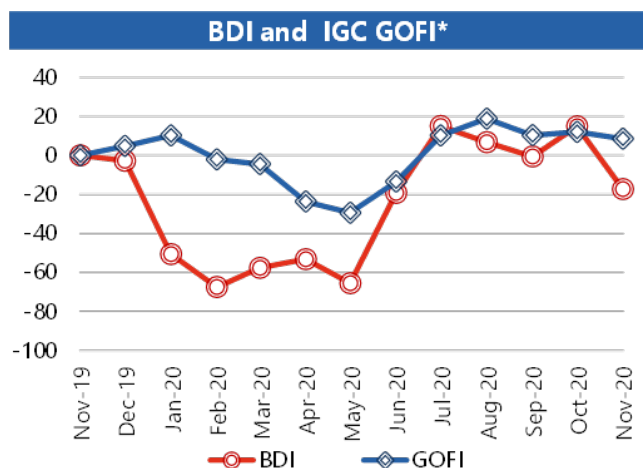
	November-20 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
Baltic Dry Index (BDI)*	1172.9	-28.1%	-17.4%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
Capesize	1599.7	-43.9%	-40.6%
Panamax	1259.8	-6.4%	+3.0%
Supramax	915.4	-6.2%	+12.7%
Baltic Handysize Index (BHSI)**	592.2	-0.6%	+13.6%

Sources: Baltic Exchange, IGC.

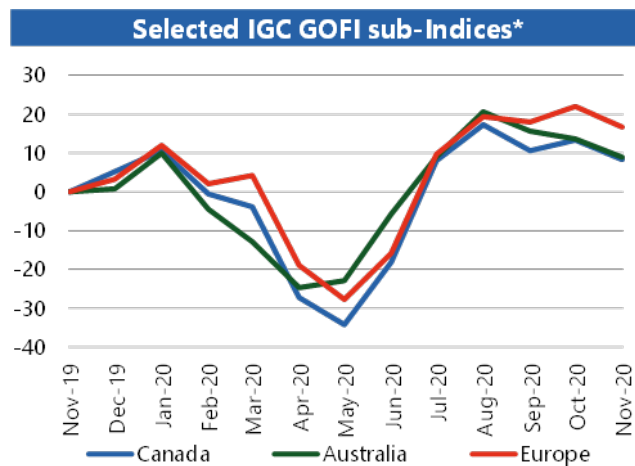
*4 January 1985 = 1000. **23 May 2006 = 1000.

***1 January 2013 = 100.

	November-20 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)***	112.3	-3.1%	+8.5%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
Argentina	138.9	-1.5%	+13.0%
Australia	71.0	-4.1%	+8.9%
Brazil	145.2	-2.6%	+10.6%
Black Sea	118.0	-3.9%	+11.8%
Canada	93.8	-4.4%	+8.3%
Europe	100.0	-4.4%	+16.7%
US	94.6	-3.5%	+6.3%



*percentage change based on monthly average values



- In the past month, buoyant activity in global grains and oilseeds markets supported sentiment across associated carrying sectors. However, with weaker rates for Capesize vessels, which mainly transport ores and heavy raw materials, average **Baltic Dry Index (BDI)** values dropped by 28 percent m/m, to a five-month low.
- With demand falling short of expectations, the **Capesize** sub-Index posted a monthly loss of 44 percent. While values were quoted at their lowest in five months at times, rates remained well above levels seen at the time of COVID-19-related lockdowns in the early months of 2020, when average values dipped into negative territory for the first time ever.
- Panamax** quotations were 6 percent lower on average compared to October. Reduced enquiry levels in South America and a long ballast list at the US Gulf initially pressured values, more than offsetting strong mineral-related activity in the Baltic Sea region, coupled with brisk deliveries out of the northern Pacific. The sub-Index edged higher mid-month on strengthening fundamentals in the Atlantic and firming rates in parts of Asia.
- Supramax** and **Handysize** rates averaged 6 percent and 1 percent lower m/m, respectively. Limited demand in some regions, including in the eastern Mediterranean and the Black Sea, was an initial bearish influence, but more recent strength was linked to new business in Europe and at the US Gulf, with activity in Southeast Asia also accelerating. Recent steady increases in the Handysize sector were also linked to tightening tonnage availability in northern Brazil.
- Rebounding vessel hire prices offered support to voyage freight quotations at key grains and oilseeds origins in the latter half of November. Still, the IGC **Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)** averaged slightly lower m/m.



Source: International Grains Council

Baltic Dry Index (BDI): A benchmark indicator issued daily by the Baltic Exchange, providing assessed costs of moving raw materials on ocean going vessels. Comprises sub-Indices for three segments: Capesize, Panamax and Supramax. The Baltic Handysize Index excluded from the BDI from 1 March 2018.

IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI): A trade-weighted composite measure of ocean freight costs for grains and oilseeds, issued daily by the International Grains Council. Includes sub-Indices for seven main origins (Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Black Sea, Canada, the EU and the USA). Constructed based on nominal HSS (heavy grains, soybeans, sorghum) voyage rates on selected major routes.

Capesize: Vessels with deadweight tonnage (DWT) above 80,000 DWT, primarily transporting coal, iron ore and other heavy raw materials on long-haul routes.

Panamax: Carriers with capacity of 60,000-80,000 DWT, mostly geared to transporting coal, grains, oilseeds and other bulks, including sugar and cement.

Supramax/Handysize: Ships with capacity below 60,000 DWT, accounting for the majority of the world's ocean-going vessels and able to transport a wide variety of cargos, including grains and oilseeds.

Explanatory notes

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of “Markets at a glance” reflect judgmental views that take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA. For the former, they also take into account information provided by AMIS focal points (hence the notion “FAO-AMIS”). World estimates and forecasts produced by the three sources may vary due to several reasons, such as varying release dates and different methodologies used in constructing commodity balances. Specifically:

Production: Wheat production data from all three sources refer to production occurring in the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. crops harvested in 2016 are allocated to the 2016/17 marketing season). Maize and rice production data for FAO-AMIS refer to crops harvested during the first year of the marketing season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season) in both the northern and southern hemisphere. Rice production data for FAO-AMIS also include northern hemisphere production from secondary crops harvested in the second year of the marketing season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). By contrast, rice and maize data for USDA and IGC encompass production in the northern hemisphere occurring during the first year of the season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season), as well as crops harvested in the southern hemisphere during the second year of the season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). For soybeans, the latter approach is used by all three sources.

Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks by all three sources.

Utilization: For all three sources, wheat, maize and rice utilization includes food, feed and other uses (namely, seeds, industrial uses and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. However, for all AMIS commodities, the use categories may be grouped differently across sources and may also include residual values.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June basis, except for USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. Wheat trade data from all three sources includes wheat flour in wheat grain equivalent, while the USDA also considers wheat products. For rice, trade covers shipments from January to December of the second year of the respective marketing season. For soybeans, trade is reported on an October/September basis by FAO-AMIS and the IGC, while USDA data are based on local marketing years except for Argentina and Brazil which are reported on an October/September basis. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Stocks: In general, world stocks of AMIS crops refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. For soybeans, stock levels reported by the USDA are based on local marketing years, except for Argentina and Brazil, which are adjusted to October/September. For maize and rice, global estimates may vary across sources because of differences in the allocation of production in southern hemisphere countries.

For more information on AMIS Supply and Demand, please view [AMIS Supply and Demand Balances Manual](#).

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, IFPRI, IGC, OECD, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve, WTO

AMIS - GEOGLAM Crop Calendar

Selected leading producers

Wheat		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
EU (21%)*	winter												
China (17%)	spring												
	winter												
India (13%)	winter												
US (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Russia (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Maize		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
US (35%)													
China (22%)	north												
	south												
Brazil (8%)	1st crop												
	2nd crop												
EU (7%)													
Argentina (3%)													
Rice		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
China (29%)	intermediary crop												
	late crop												
	early crop												
India (21%)	kharif												
	rabi												
Indonesia (9%)	main Java												
	second Java												
Viet Nam (6%)	winter-spring												
	summer/autumn												
	winter												
Thailand (4%)	main season												
	second season												
Soybeans		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
USA (31%)													
Brazil (29%)													
Argentina (18%)													
China (4%)													
India (3%)													

* Percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2013-15).

	Planting (peak)		Harvest (peak)
	Planting		Harvest
	Weather conditions in this period are critical for yields.		Growing period

2021 AMIS Market Monitor Release Dates

February 4, March 4, April 8, May 6, June 3, July 8, September 2, October 7, November 4, December 2

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